

3.2 Assessment information

Controlled conditions

These activities must all be carried out under controlled conditions. Students will be allowed to write up their practical reports in a separate lesson, but their materials must be collected at the end of the session and handed back at the beginning of the next session. Students are not permitted to work on their practical sheets out of the lesson. Students' work must be individual and they may not work with other students in groups.

Assessed practical sheets

The practical sheets for activities **b**, **c** and **d** are confidential and must not be shown to students prior to their completion of them. They will be available on a secure Edexcel website for teachers to download in preparation for delivery.

Activities

Activity a: General Practical Competence (GPC)

This will confirm that the students have completed a range of practicals over the whole year and developed their laboratory skills. Students must have carried out at least five practicals in class. By completing these practicals students will be able to:

- follow and interpret experimental instructions, covering the full range of laboratory exercises set throughout the course, with minimal help from the teacher
- always work with interest and enthusiasm in the laboratory completing most laboratory exercises in the time allocated
- manipulate apparatus, use chemicals, carry out all common laboratory procedures and use data logging (where appropriate) with the highest level of skill that may be reasonably expected at this level
- work sensibly and safely in the laboratory paying due regard to health and safety requirements without the need for reminders from the teacher
- gain accurate and consistent results in quantitative exercises, make most of the expected observations in qualitative exercises and obtain products in preparations of high yield and purity.

Verification of completion of these practicals is required as well as the core practical code, or title of an alternative practical, field of chemistry and dates on which the practicals were carried out. There will be no separate mark awarded for these practical activities.

Activity b: Qualitative observation

Students must complete one qualitative observation, from the selection provided by Edexcel. This activity will include a student sheet, teacher and technician notes and a mark scheme. The activity is marked out of 14.

Activity c: Quantitative measurement

Students must complete one quantitative measurement, from the selection provided by Edexcel. This activity will include a student sheet, teacher and technician notes and a mark scheme. The activity is marked out of 14.